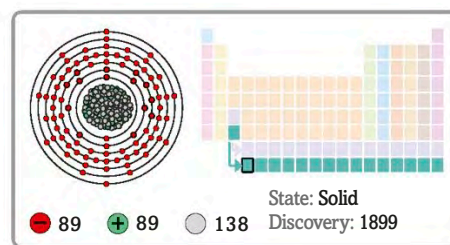


89
Ac

Actinium



Autunite

This radioactive mineral glows brightly in ultraviolet light.

Uranite

This ore contains uranium, which breaks down into actinium.



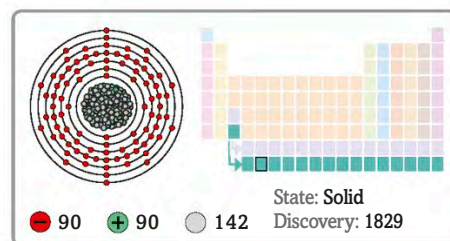
This device uses radioactive actinium to measure the amount of water.

Neutron probe

Rare in nature, actinium is a metal formed by the decay of other radioactive elements. Its atoms are unstable and break down to make the elements francium and radon. Actinium is found in tiny amounts in uranium ores, such as **uranite**, and has limited applications. Its isotopes are used in radiation therapy to treat cancer.

90
Th

Thorium



Monazite

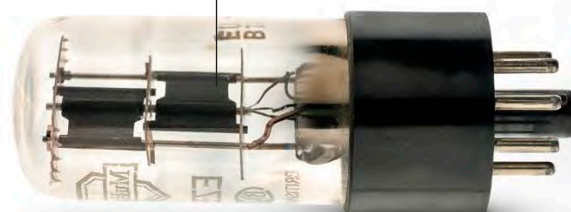
The most common natural radioactive metal, thorium is used inside vacuum tubes to allow an electric current to flow. It can also undergo nuclear fission, a process in which atoms split in two and release energy. Scientists are exploring ways of making thorium-powered nuclear reactors that produce electricity.

This durable rock made of solidified lava contains 12% thorium.

This thorium coating creates an electric current by releasing electrons.

Thorianite

This ore contains small crystals of thorium compounds.



Vacuum tube